

- Child care
- Child support or alimony
- Insurance
- Out-of-pocket medical expenses
- Computer expenses
- Entertainment/recreation
- Eating out/groceries
- Clothing and shoes
- Gifts and donations
- Hobbies
- Interest expense
- Household/personal care products
- Federal, state, and local income tax
- Social security tax
- Property tax
- Retirement contributions
- Investments
- Pet expenses

Don't forget things that come up throughout the year but are not monthly expenses, such as subscriptions, holiday gifts, clothing, birthday gifts, insurance, maintenance agreements, adult education classes or seminars, car repairs, medical expenses, and so forth.

Think about your own personal habits (smoking, drinking, buying lunch at work) or hobbies you engage in (woodworking, skiing, boating, golfing, gardening) to identify other spending categories. Some of your spending habits might make you uncomfortable when confronted in black and white. That's okay. Identifying them doesn't change the facts; it just brings them to light so you can make a conscious decision about your spending. The purpose of budgeting is not to make you feel guilty about how you've spent your money in the past.

